

UFO Sightings Investigation

Scenario Demonstration — Pack Introduction



Difficulty: 4 of 5 — Advanced

What this pack is

This is a practice Scenario Demonstration pack modelled on the City & Guilds 9665 Data Technician end-point assessment. It contains four parts: this introduction, the Scenario Demonstration brief, the data files, and a Learner Guide showing how the task can be approached and the results you should expect to reach.

What is being looked at

This is a cleaning-focused scenario built on deliberately messy data. It exercises text-cleaning functions, a blend that does not fully match, and a full toolkit of conditional and aggregate functions. The areas examined are:

Area examined	Where it appears
Importing and organising data into a workbook	Scenario 1, Task 1
Inspecting data for quality problems (sort/filter)	Scenario 1, Task 2
Cleaning text — TRIM, PROPER, UPPER, Remove Duplicates	Scenario 1, Task 3
Blending tables with a lookup, and handling failed matches	Scenario 1, Task 4
Conditional logic and calculated columns (IF, division)	Scenario 2, Task 1
Conditional formatting to highlight cases	Scenario 2, Task 2
Conditional aggregation (SUMIF, AVERAGEIF)	Scenario 2, Task 3
Pivot Table and Pivot Chart by region	Scenario 2, Task 4
Interpreting patterns and relationships	Scenario 2, Task 5

Why this is rated 4 stars

The analysis steps are guided, but the data is genuinely messy and the cleaning is where the marks are won or lost. There are several distinct, realistic data-quality traps to find and fix before any analysis is trustworthy, and the blend deliberately includes a sighting whose agent

does not exist — testing whether the learner notices and explains a failed lookup rather than hiding it. It stops short of 5 stars because the analysis itself is specified rather than open-ended.

Areas to watch

- **Whitespace and casing:** names, regions and status fields have leading/trailing and double spaces and mixed case (" Dana scully ", "FOX MULDER") — TRIM and PROPER fix these.
- **Duplicate AgentID:** A020 appears twice — use Remove Duplicates.
- **Inconsistent region names:** watch for a mis-spelling ("Scotand" → "Scotland") and a double-spaced "East Of England" that will split your regional totals if not reconciled.
- **Mixed date formats:** the Date field mixes dd/mm/yy, dd-mm-yyyy and d/mm/yy — standardise it.
- **A failed lookup:** one sighting references an AgentID that doesn't exist — report it, don't silently hide the #N/A.

What's in the pack

- **Scenario Demonstration – UFO Sightings Investigation** (PDF) — the brief, in C&G format.
- **SightingReports.csv** — UFO sightings recorded by agents.
- **AgentProfiles.csv** — investigation agent details.
- **Annex A – Field Reference** — a data dictionary, embedded in the brief.
- **Learner Guide – UFO Sightings Investigation** (PDF) — method and expected results.